BALAAJEE VR

PRODUCT DESIGN & TECHNOLOGY EXECUTIVE • B.E. (INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY)

+91 9994761293 •
vrbberaj@gmail.com
Chennai, Tamil Nadu, India

Statement of Purpose: Reasons for Joining VIT Chennai

Candidate for Professor of Practice • School of Computer Science & Engineering (SCOPE)

01. PROFESSIONAL INTENT & ACADEMIC CALLING

After more than **18 years of directing global design, software architecture, and product innovation teams** across Fortune 500 enterprises—including **IBM Software Labs, Zebra Technologies, ZF Wabco, Ericsson, Samsung, and Infosys**—I am deliberately choosing to channel my industry experience into academia. As an engineer who began my career as a lecturer in an Anna University affiliated engineering college (2004–2006) and holds a foundational **B.E. in Information Technology**, teaching is not an alternative career for me; it is a full-circle professional calling. Joining **Vellore Institute of Technology (VIT Chennai)** as Professor of Practice represents the ideal institutional platform to bridge enterprise product standards with higher education.

02. FOUR STRATEGIC DRIVERS FOR CHOOSING VIT CHENNAI

1. Institutional Eminence & Innovation Pedagogy

ACADEMIC SYNERGY

VIT's status as an **Institution of Eminence (IoE)** and its pioneering adoption of the **Fully Flexible Credit System (FFCS)** and project-based learning create an environment where industry-aligned curricula can be rapidly implemented. Unlike rigid traditional universities, VIT has demonstrated the organizational agility required for a Professor of Practice to introduce cutting-edge coursework in **Human-Computer Interaction (HCI)**, **AI-UX interaction architectures**, and **Enterprise Design Systems**.

2. High-Impact Scale & Student Caliber at SCOPE

PEDAGOGICAL REACH

The **School of Computer Science & Engineering (SCOPE)** at VIT Chennai attracts some of the sharpest analytical minds in India. However, the contemporary tech landscape requires software engineers who understand product ergonomics, user psychology, and production-grade UI design tokens alongside backend algorithms. Mentoring SCOPE students through studio-based critiques and industry incubators allows me to directly shape the next generation of **hybrid "Design Engineers."**

3. Strategic Location in the Chennai Tech Corridor

INDUSTRY-ACADEMIA NEXUS

VIT Chennai's proximity to the OMR/GST technology corridor places it at the epicenter of India's enterprise SaaS, automotive telematics, and global capability centers (GCCs). Having directed design operations for Zebra and ZF Wabco in Chennai and IBM Software Labs, I am uniquely positioned to leverage my corporate network to establish **industry-sponsored capstone labs**, hackathons, and corporate R&D MoUs right here in Chennai.

4. Personal Roots & Long-Term Institutional Commitment

LOCAL PRESENCE

As a permanent Chennai resident, I offer complete, friction-free local commitment to VIT Chennai's campus life. I seek a multi-year engagement where I can actively participate in curriculum review boards, faculty enablement workshops, student hackathons, and corporate placement bootcamps without logistical constraints.

CORE COMMITMENTS TO VIT CHENNAI

- **Super-Dream Placement Acceleration:** Grooming SCOPE undergraduates for premier product engineering roles through design-architecture interview prep and portfolio critiques.
- **Corporate Placement & MoU Pipelines:** Connecting VIT with hiring managers and R&D directors across IBM, Zebra, Ericsson, and partner ecosystems.
- **Interdisciplinary Collaboration:** Bridging computing theory at SCOPE with design thinking and institutional technology transfer.